

### Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

**Reasoning + Answer:**

<think>

- The patient's symptoms include long-term sadness, hopelessness, suicidal ideation, and worsening of these symptoms over the past 2 weeks.
- He also feels that his life is cursed and has difficulty making decisions.
- These symptoms are consistent with depression, particularly a severe or recurrent form.
- The worsening of symptoms over time and the long-term nature of the sadness suggest a chronic condition, possibly double depression.
- Mania or psychosis would present with different symptoms, such as elevated mood, delusions, or hallucinations, which are not mentioned.
- Anhedonia is a common symptom of depression but is not specifically highlighted here.
- Paranoid personality disorder involves a pattern of distrust and suspiciousness, not the specific symptoms described.
- Given the long-term nature of the sadness and the worsening of symptoms, the best fit is double depression.
- Double depression refers to the condition where someone who already has a history of depression experiences a major depressive episode on top of their existing condition.
- This matches the patient's history of long-term sadness and the recent worsening of symptoms.
- The patient's difficulty making decisions and hopelessness are also common in depression.
- The suicidal ideation, while concerning, is not specific to mania or psychosis but is a common symptom in severe depression.
- The patient's ability to hold a job and get enough sleep suggests that they are not experiencing mania or psychosis.
- Paranoid personality disorder is not indicated by the patient's symptoms.
- Therefore, the best description of the patient's condition is that they are at risk for double depression.
- The patient's symptoms align with double depression, which is a condition where someone with a history of depression experiences a major depressive episode.
- This matches the patient's long-term sadness and recent worsening of symptoms.
- The other options do not fit the patient's symptoms as well as double depression.
- The patient's ability to hold a job and get enough sleep rules out mania or psychosis.
- The patient's symptoms do not suggest paranoid personality disorder.
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